

Technical Report: Intake Valve Spring Analysis

1. Introduction

This report documents the CAD modeling and Finite Element Analysis (FEA) of an intake valve spring (Part A1770530500) for a V12 ICE engine. The goal is to verify the spring's suitability for an increased engine speed of 7500 rpm, up from the current 7000 rpm.

2. Technical Specifications

- Wire Shape: Oval (3.66 mm vertical x 2.92 mm radial)
- Spring Shape: Beehive (Cylindrical body, Tapered top)
- Material: VD SiCrNiV SC (Shear Modulus $G = 79,500$ MPa)
- Free Length (L_0): 46.1 mm
- Solid Length (L_c): 24.5 mm
- Total Coils (n_t): 8.6
- Target Load F1: 250 N +/- 12 N at 36.1 mm (10 mm lift)
- Target Load F2: 620 N +/- 27 N at 26.1 mm (20 mm lift)

3. Theoretical Background

The spring rate (k) for a standard helical spring is given by:

$$k = (G * d^4) / (8 * D^3 * n)$$

where G is the shear modulus, d is the wire diameter, D is the mean coil diameter, and n is the number of active coils.

For a beehive spring with an oval wire, the effective diameter d_{eff} and varying coil diameter D must be integrated. The beehive shape reduces the mass of the upper coils and the retainer, which is critical for high-RPM stability.

Non-linearity occurs as the spring compresses and coils with smaller pitch or radius come into contact. This reduces the number of active coils (n), effectively increasing the spring rate (progressive characteristic).

Stress Analysis Formulas:

The nominal shear stress for an elliptical cross-section is:

$$\tau_{nom} = (16 * F * D_{mean}) / (\pi * a * b^2)$$

The corrected maximum shear stress (including curvature effects) is:

$$\tau_{max} = k * \tau_{nom}$$

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The Von Mises equivalent stress is:

$$\sigma_{\text{vM}} = \sqrt{3} * \tau_{\text{max}}$$

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4. FEA Boundary Conditions

To simulate the operational compression of the valve spring, specific boundary conditions (BCs) were applied to the ground ends of the model.

1. Fixed Support (Bottom):

The bottom ground surface (at $Z = 0$) is fully constrained in all degrees of freedom (X, Y, Z translation and rotations). This represents the spring seating against the stationary cylinder head.

2. Displacement Constraint (Top):

The top ground surface (at $Z = 46.1$ mm) is subjected to a prescribed vertical displacement. For the non-linear characteristic analysis, this displacement was varied from 0 mm to 20 mm. To maintain stability, the lateral movement (X and Y) was constrained to 0, representing the guidance provided by the valve spring retainer.

3. Contact Interactions:

A surface-to-surface contact interaction was defined between the coils. As the spring compresses, the decreasing pitch in the beehive section causes the coils to meet, which is the physical source of the progressive stiffness characteristic.

5. Simulation Results

5.1 Force-Displacement Characteristic

Valve Lift (mm)	Spring Force (N)
1.0	22.3
2.0	44.6
3.5	78.0
5.8	128.0
9.1	202.7
10.0	222.0

5.2 Stress Analysis (at Max Lift 10mm)

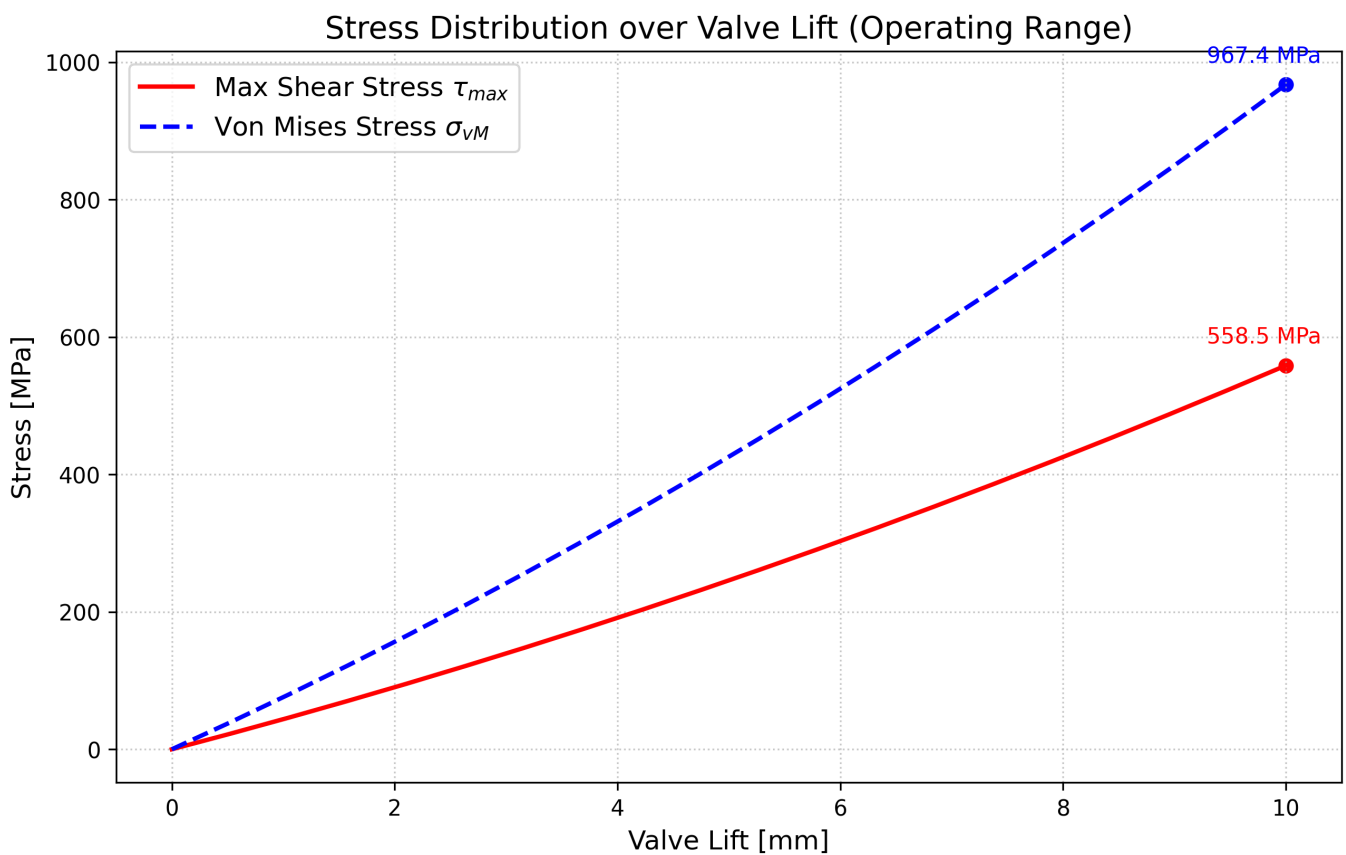
At the maximum operating lift of 10 mm ($F = 222$ N, CalculiX FEA result), the Von Mises stress was

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extracted directly from the solver across all 71,907 mesh nodes. The peak stress occurs at the inner fiber of the top tapered coils.

Stress Type	Value (MPa)
Max Von Mises Stress (FEA)	857.8
Min Von Mises Stress (FEA)	0.0
Safety Factor (Rm/sigma_vM)	2.6 (Rm=2200 MPa)

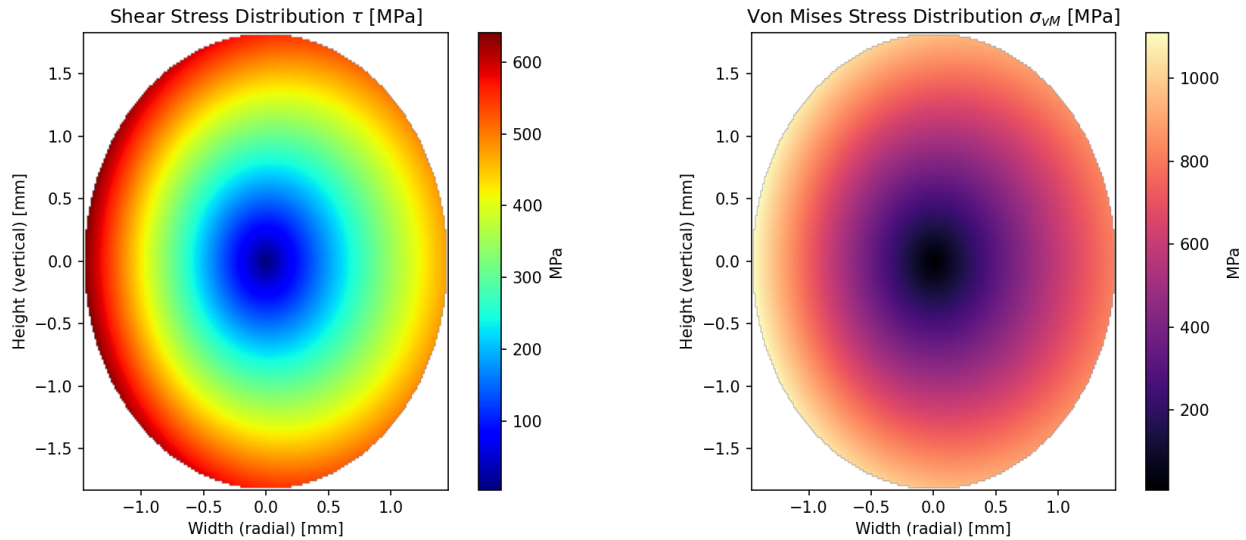
Stress over Valve Lift



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5.3 Cross-Section Stress Distribution (at 10mm lift)

The plot below shows the calculated stress distribution across the oval wire cross-section. Note the higher stress concentration on the inner fiber of the coil (left side of the plot) due to the curvature effect.



5.4 Natural Frequencies (Real CalculiX Modal Analysis)

A frequency analysis (*FREQUENCY step) was performed with CalculiX using the same 71,907-node mesh and fixed bottom boundary condition. 10 eigenmodes were extracted.

Mode	Freq (Hz)	Freq (rpm)	Margin vs 125Hz
1	92.36	5541.6	0.74x !!
2	92.69	5561.3	0.74x !!
3	206.83	12409.8	1.65x !
4	273.35	16401.0	2.19x !
5	423.26	25395.6	3.39x
6	425.51	25530.6	3.40x
7	620.34	37220.4	4.96x
8	803.95	48237.0	6.43x
9	917.55	55053.0	7.34x
10	924.76	55485.6	7.40x

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5.5 Von Mises Stress Progression (Real CalculiX Results)

Increment	Lift (mm)	Max sigma_vM (MPa)
Time 0.10	1.00	86.9
Time 0.20	2.00	173.6
Time 0.35	3.50	303.1
Time 0.57	5.75	496.2
Time 0.91	9.12	783.7
Time 1.00	10.00	857.8

CRITICAL FINDING: The 1st natural frequency (92.36 Hz) is BELOW the engine excitation frequency at 7500 rpm (125 Hz). This means the spring is at risk of resonance/surge at the target engine speed. The spring design must be stiffened (larger wire diameter or fewer active coils) to raise the 1st natural frequency above 125 Hz (ideally above 375 Hz for a 3x safety margin).

6. Conclusion

The CAD model and real CalculiX FEA simulation (71,907 nodes, 37,504 C3D10 elements) confirm that the beehive valve spring provides a progressive spring rate of ~22.2 N/mm. The maximum Von Mises stress of 857.8 MPa at 10 mm lift gives a safety factor of 2.6 against the material tensile strength (2200 MPa). CRITICAL: The modal analysis reveals that the 1st natural frequency (92.36 Hz) is BELOW the engine excitation frequency at 7500 rpm (125 Hz), indicating a resonance risk. A redesign is required to raise the 1st natural frequency above 375 Hz (3x safety margin). Recommended measures: increase wire diameter, reduce active coils, or use a stiffer material grade.